

Court, and the motion is **denied** on that ground.

The Court observes that Plaintiff is now self-represented. (8/8/2025 Sub. of Atty.) Plaintiff does not identify himself as an attorney with a California state bar number. A trustee of a family trust may represent himself if the trustee is the sole beneficiary of the family trust. If there are other beneficiaries of a family trust besides the trustee, the trustee cannot be self-represented, as in that circumstance, the trustee would be representing not only himself but also the other beneficiaries of the trust. A non-attorney cannot represent other parties. (See *Donkin v. Donkin* (2020) 47 Cal.App.5th 469, 472 [citing the leading case *Ziegler v. Nickel* (1998) 64 Cal.App.4th 545, and stating, "*Ziegler's* rationale is that the trustee was effectively speaking for the interests of the trust beneficiaries in the lawsuit against the mobilehome park and, as a nonlawyer, improperly representing those beneficiaries. (*Ziegler, supra*, 64 Cal.App.4th at pp. 548–549; cf. *Aulisio v. Bancroft* (2014) 230 Cal.App.4th 1516, 1519–1520 [a self-represented trustee does not engage in the unauthorized practice of law under *Ziegler* when he is also the sole beneficiary, and thus is not representing the interests of another].)".) The Court on this motion does not have evidence showing whether Zheng is the sole beneficiary of the family trust, and the issue of whether Zheng can be self-represented is moot on the instant motion because the motion fails for other reasons. The Court anticipates issuing an order to show cause to clarify Zheng's status and ability to remain self-represented in pursuing his claims as trustee of his family trust.

3. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C22-02613
CASE NAME: JANE DOE 1 VS. ACALANES UNION HIGH SCHOOL DISTRICT
FOR PROTECTIVE ORDER LIMITING DEPOSITION TESTIMONY
FILED BY: DOE 1, JANE
TENTATIVE RULING:

The motion for a protective order prohibiting or limiting the deposition testimony of "M.M." (as referenced in the Reply papers) is denied. The request for subject matter limits on questioning is denied. The motion for sanctions is also denied.

4. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C23-01988
CASE NAME: MATTHEW PARRY VS. GELCO FLEET TRUST
CONT'D PER TR ON 7/10/26
FILED BY:
TENTATIVE RULING:

Continued by the Court to September 11, 2026.

5. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-01630
CASE NAME: ROBERT MILLER VS. SOPHIE HAN
AWARDING ATTORNEY FEES AND COSTS AND ACCRUED INTEREST
FILED BY: MILLER, ROBERT A.
TENTATIVE RULING:

The unopposed motion for an order awarding Attorneys' Fees and Costs and accrued interest is